

To help explain this concept of primary and secondary types, let's look at the Gallup Clifton Strengths model, which was developed by Dan Clifton, the researcher who designed the speed-reading study from [Chapter 8](#). When Gallup determine your combination of 34 strengths, they don't suggest you have one dominant strength to rule them all (sorry—couldn't help myself). Instead, of the 34 strengths they've identified, they talk about your top 5, your dominant strengths (usually your top 12) and your lesser strengths (usually your bottom 12).

Within the 34 strengths, there are four distinct domains of strength: Strategic Thinking, Relationship Building, Influencing and Executing. Each theme provides a way to describe what you naturally do best or which areas you might need help from others. Gallup don't suggest that all your strengths will be found in one theme. Or that all your 5 most dominant strengths will be found in one theme. It's highly unusual to only be Strategic Thinking, only Relationship Building, only Influencing or only Execution. In fact, because there are fewer than 12 strengths within each theme, it's almost impossible for your dominant strengths to comprise only one of the four themes.

That's why when Gallup researched strengths, they discovered almost all of us have dominant themes and lesser themes. According to Gallup, 'Your dominant themes ... are packed with the most potential. These are the talents that give you power—the ones that separate you from the crowd. Your dominant themes are those you lead with. No matter what the situation, they filter your world, forcing you to behave in certain recurring ways.'

It's the same with your Money Types. Your dominant, or primary, Money Type carries the most financial potential and has the ability to be your superpower. However, your dominant traits, if misused or misapplied, can also hinder your effectiveness and even turn into a weakness. For example, a Discerner's ability to make sense of information might be their strength, but if they start to over analyse and are paralysed as a result then this strength has become their weakness. Understanding how to proactively use the strengths of your Money Type is the key to achieving your financial potential.

Your lesser, or secondary, Money Type might explain those strengths or traits that occasionally occur in your financial behaviours and thoughts. You might use these types in connection with your primary Money Type, or perhaps they only appear in times of stress. What's important is to know you have them to some degree and that they not impede your financial growth.